

Apple iPhone 15 Pro

Biggest iPhone upgrade mired by issues

This year, the 'Pro' models in the Apple iPhone 15 series come with big changes. We FINALLY have a USB type-C port, a new Action Button which replaces the alert slider, the brand new Apple A17 Bionic chip, and Apple's new camera smarts to compliment all of that. But that's not all. We get a new Titanium Frame with a slimmer and lighter build. Amidst all the complaints and issues popping up, I put the phone through our test process to see how well it holds up.

DESIGN

This year, Apple has moved to a Titanium frame on the iPhone 15 Pro and iPhone 15 Pro Max, moving away from the stainless steel frame that last year's iPhone 14 Pro models had. There's a good 19 grams weight reduction makes a lot of difference when you hold these two phones side-to-side.

Another design change this year is that the iPhone 15 Pro is marginally slimmer than the iPhone 14 Pro, and the edges are a bit rounded off in order to make the grip a bit better and easier. The frames on the iPhone 15 Pro and Pro Max don't really look as "premium" as compared to the stainless steel frames on the previous Pro models. Furthermore, the titanium on iPhone 15 Pro gets smudges way too easily.

Now coming to the design element that is being criticised the most, the build quality. Yes, from the moment you hold the new iPhone 15 Pro it doesn't feel as sturdy and well-built as the previous Pro variants. But that is all for a good reason – to reduce the weight. The phone may not feel as well-built, but in my experience, it doesn't feel that it is too fragile to just break into two pieces,

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unless of course my intention is to break it into two.

This year, Apple has removed the metal back plate that was placed on the back of the glass panel last year. With the iPhone 15 Pro, the company has put that metal plate on the smartphone itself, which

does make it more fragile, but at the same time, this makes replacing the back glass easier.

From a distance, the iPhone 15 Pro looks the same as the Apple iPhone 14 Pro. There are subtle differences. The edges aren't as sharp and the slightly slimmer profile makes the smartphone marginally more handy as well.

DISPLAY

Coming to display, the Super Retina XDR AMOLED panel with ProMotion has been one of the bigger upgrades in the iPhone's display since last year. The 6.1-inch 2K panel on the iPhone 15 Pro is also the brightest display we have ever seen on any iPhone so far. Apple

claims a peak brightness of 2000 nits. I used a Lux Meter to test the maximum luminance of the iPhone 15 Pro and the smartphone showed a peak brightness of 1998 on a plain white screen under bright sunlight. The ProMotion display works well, and there is a visible difference between the 60Hz iPhone 14 that I had used before this and the 120Hz refresh rate on the iPhone 15 Pro.

PERFORMANCE

Coming to performance, the Apple iPhone 15 Pro has the new Apple A17 Pro chipset, which is the world's first 3nm chip on a smartphone, and the new chip promises a lot! Before I get into my experience with the smartphone, let us address the major issues that have been coming up with the new iPhone 15 series. Issues that concern the performance of the smartphone like heating. The heating issues with the new iPhone were said to be due to the lack of a good thermal system design due to the slimmer and lighter design. However, Apple has now said that this is due to a software issue. In a statement, the Cupertino-based giant has said that the new iPhone 15 series may feel "warmer during the first few days after setting up because of increased background activity." Apple has also said that some recent updates to third-party apps are causing them to overload the system.

My unit of the iPhone 15 Pro did definitely heat up while doing intensive tasks like using the camera or while playing games. However, during normal conditions, it is very random. For example, while browsing through social media and stuff, the iPhone 15 Pro won't heat up, but the smartphone may just heat up while it's in my pocket and I'm listening to music through my earphones. Even while charging the iPhone 15 Pro heats up sometimes, but sometimes it is absolutely normal.

Coming to the biggest upgrade this year, type-C! With type-C, the Apple iPhone has finally been opened up to new possibilities. We get on-drive data processing, faster data transfer speeds (although the iPhone 15 and iPhone 15